Ironically, ABVKA's growth strategy replicated the social-welfare work done by the Christian missionaries it had been formed to oppose and whom it saw as a civilisational threat. It emulated and adapted many of the outreach tactics of these missions as it expanded across India. Just as Church missionaries created hospitals, schools and orphanages,[60] by 2019, ABVKA was directly benefitting 5,87,768 tribals in one way or another. Its biggest emphasis was on healthcare (67.8 per cent), followed by education (23.9 per cent) and direct financial aid (8.3 per cent), as Figure 14.2 shows.

By 2019, in fact, the ABVKA had significantly scaled up its growth. It claimed to have initiated contact in 345 of India's 727 districts in its online interactive management dashboard. It estimated that as many as 447 of India's districts had tribal populations.[61] The data illustrates a determined push into this demography. ABVKA claimed to have established committees in 323 districts; its committees were actively working in 52,323 villages (see Figure 14.1).[62] This increased penetration was, of course, focused largely on tribal districts. Therefore, in Karnataka, for example, according to the RSS workers I met in Bengaluru, the ABVKA was growing in Coorg, Goondlepet, Ambikanagar, Dandeli and Sulya in Dakshin Kannada.[63]

Figure 14.1: ABVKA's Penetration by District, Block and Village in Tribal Populations